

THE MONK

CLASS HANDBOOK



Fast, Focused, and Furious!

Do you want to be a martial arts master who can catch arrows out of the air and run up walls? The Monk doesn't need heavy armor or giant swords. You use your speed, agility, and a magical energy called Ki to punch, kick, and dodge faster than anyone else!



CLASS MECHANICS

MARTIAL ARTS

Your hands and feet are deadly weapons! When you attack with a Monk weapon (like a staff or nunchucks) or an unarmed strike, you can use your **Dexterity** instead of Strength. Even better, when you use your Action to attack, you can make one unarmed strike as a **Bonus Action** for free!

KI POINTS

Starting at level 2, you get **Ki points** (magical energy). You can spend these points to do amazing ninja moves:

- **Flurry of Blows:** Spend 1 Ki point to make TWO unarmed strikes as a Bonus Action!

- **Patient Defense:** Spend 1 Ki point to take the Dodge action as a Bonus Action.
- **Step of the Wind:** Spend 1 Ki point to Disengage or Dash as a Bonus Action, and your jump distance is doubled!

UNARMORED DEFENSE

Monks are too fast to hit! If you aren't wearing armor or using a shield, your Armor Class (AC) is **10 + your Dexterity modifier + your Wisdom modifier**.

STRENGTHS

- **Super Fast:** You have the highest movement speed in the game. You can run all the way across the battlefield in seconds!
- **Lots of Attacks:** With Flurry of Blows, you can hit enemies many times in a single turn.
- **Great Defense:** You are amazing at dodging attacks and spells.

WEAKNESSES

- **Low Health:** You don't have as many Hit Points as a Fighter or Barbarian, so you can't take too many hits.
- **Ki Dependent:** If you run out of Ki points, you lose a lot of your coolest powers (but they come back after a short rest!).

LEVELING UP

As you train your mind and body, you unlock incredible new abilities. Watch your Monk grow from a martial arts student to a legendary master!

LEVEL	AWESOME NEW POWERS!
1	Unarmored Defense & Martial Arts: You are fast enough to dodge without armor, and your punches are as strong as weapons!
2	Ki Points & Fast Movement: You unlock your magical Ki energy! You also permanently get faster, letting you outrun almost anyone.
3	Monastic Tradition & Deflect Missiles: You choose your Monk subclass! Even cooler, if someone shoots an arrow at you, you can use your reaction to CATCH IT out of the air!
4	Slow Fall & Ability Score Improvement: You can fall from super high places and use your acrobatics to take almost no damage! You also get to boost your Dexterity or Wisdom.
5	Extra Attack & Stunning Strike: You can attack twice per turn! Also, you can spend a Ki point when you punch someone to completely STUN them, making them unable to move or act!

LEVELING UP TIP!

Your two most important stats are **Dexterity** (for punching and dodging) and **Wisdom** (for your Ki abilities). Try to get both of them as high as possible!

SUBCLASSES: MONASTIC TRADITIONS

At Level 3, you choose your "Monastic Tradition." This is the special school of martial arts you follow. Here are two amazingly fun subclasses to choose from:

WAY OF THE OPEN HAND

This is the ultimate kung fu master! You focus entirely on making your punches and kicks as powerful and tricky as possible. You learn how to knock bad guys flying across the room!

- **Open Hand Technique:** Whenever you use Flurry of Blows, you can add extra effects to your punches! You can:
 - Knock the enemy completely flat on their back!
 - Push the enemy 15 feet away from you!
 - Stop the enemy from taking reactions, allowing you to run away safely!

WAY OF THE FOUR ELEMENTS

Do you want to control the elements like the Avatar? This tradition teaches you how to bend fire, water, earth, and air using your martial arts!

- **Elemental Disciplines:** You can spend your Ki points to cast elemental spells while you fight!
- **Fangs of the Fire Snake:** Your punches stretch out with ribbons of fire, letting you punch bad guys from far away with fiery damage!
- **Water Whip:** You can create a giant whip made of water that can pull enemies toward you or knock them down!
- **Fist of Unbroken Air:** You punch the air so hard that it creates a blast of wind, pushing enemies away like a hurricane!

GEAR & STRATEGY

WHAT GEAR SHOULD I USE?

Monks travel light! You don't need much to be dangerous.

- **Armor:** None! Armor slows you down. Your Unarmored Defense is all you need.
- **Weapons:** A Quarterstaff or a Spear. You can hold them with two hands for extra damage, and then use your Bonus Action to kick! Darts are great for throwing from a distance.
- **Items:** A simple backpack, a water skin, and some rope. You rely on your skills, not heavy backpacks!

HOW TO FIGHT LIKE A MONK

You are a **Hit-and-Run Skirmisher**. You should never stand perfectly still in a fight!

- **Target the Weak:** Use your super speed to run past the big, slow monsters in the front. Run right to the enemy spellcasters or archers hiding in the back and beat them up!
- **Stun the Boss:** At level 5, Stunning Strike is your best friend. If you hit the biggest, scariest boss monster and Stun them, your whole team will easily defeat them while they can't move!
- **Use Step of the Wind:** If you are surrounded by too many enemies and getting hurt, spend 1 Ki point to Disengage and run away as fast as lightning.

STRATEGY SECRET

Always remember you have a Bonus Action punch! If you use a Quarterstaff with your main Action, don't forget to declare "And then I do a spinning kick as my Bonus Action!" for extra free damage.

ROLEPLAYING YOUR MONK

Monks are usually very disciplined, but that doesn't mean they are boring! Your Monk could be a wise old master, a mischievous ninja, or a young student eager to prove themselves.

WHERE DID YOU COME FROM?

- **The Hidden Monastery:** You grew up in a temple high on a snowy mountain, studying ancient scrolls and practicing kicks in the snow.
- **The Street Fighter:** You didn't go to a fancy school. You learned to fight on the tough city streets to protect your friends.
- **The Traveling Seeker:** You left your temple to travel the whole world, seeking to learn every martial art style from every master you can find!

FUN QUIRKS & HABITS

Give your character a fun habit to make them memorable!

- You insist on meditating for one hour every morning, no matter what crazy adventure is happening.

- You love to give confusing, wise-sounding proverbs to your friends (like "The flowing river does not ask the rock for directions").
- You love eating, and you are always looking for new, exotic foods to try in every town.
- Before a fight starts, you calmly bow to your enemies as a sign of respect.

BE THE VOICE OF REASON!

When the rest of the party is arguing about what to do, you can sit down quietly, close your eyes, and suggest a calm, smart plan. You are the peaceful center of the group!

LEVELING UP (LEVELS 6 TO 10)

Your speed and power are reaching amazing new levels! From levels 6 to 10, you become a master of magical Ki energy.

LEVEL	AWESOME NEW POWERS!
6	Ki-Empowered Strikes: Your punches and kicks are now counted as magical! This means you can easily hurt ghosts, gargoyles, and monsters that ignore normal weapons. Plus, your subclass gives you a cool new power!
7	Evasion & Stillness of Mind: If a dragon breathes fire at you, you can magically dodge completely out of the way and take zero damage! You can also cure yourself if someone tries to mind-control you.
8	Ability Score Improvement: Boost your Dexterity to punch harder and dodge better, or boost your Wisdom to give yourself more Ki energy!
9	Unarmored Movement Improvement: This is amazing! You run so fast that you can now run straight up vertical walls and even run across the top of water without sinking!
10	Purity of Body: Your body is so healthy and strong that you can never be poisoned or get sick from a disease ever again!

LEVELING UP TIP!

Running on walls opens up so many fun tricks! Run up a wall to drop-kick a flying monster, or run across a river to escape the bad guys!

FAMOUS HEROES & LEGENDS

Throughout history, incredible Monks have used their speed and discipline to save the world. Here are a few legendary heroes to inspire you:

BEAUREGARD LIONETT

A tough, sarcastic human monk who wears cool blue robes. She uses a super cool staff, loves to punch bad guys with lightning-fast strikes, and works as a secret agent trying to uncover evil plots!

AANG, THE AVATAR

While technically from another universe, Aang is the perfect example of a Four Elements Monk! He uses an air glider, rarely wears armor, and uses martial arts to bend the elements to defeat the bad guys peacefully.

THE DRAGON WARRIOR

A mythical martial artist chosen by destiny to learn the secret of the Dragon Scroll. They proved that anyone—even a giant panda who loves dumplings—can become a legendary kung fu master with enough practice!

CREATE YOUR LEGEND

What will your story be? Will you be the quiet, mysterious ninja, or the loud, laughing hero who jumps off walls?

BEST MAGIC ITEMS

As you explore ancient temples and deep dungeons, look for these amazing magic items that are absolutely perfect for a Monk!

BRACERS OF DEFENSE

Since Monks don't wear armor, these magical arm-bands are perfect! They give you a huge +2 boost to your Armor Class, making you even harder to hit as you flip and dodge.

BOOTS OF SPEED

You are already the fastest person in the game... but with these boots, your speed doubles! You can run across the entire battlefield in the blink of an eye like a superhero!

WINGED BOOTS

Click your heels together, and magical wings pop out of these boots! You gain a flying speed for up to four hours, letting you soar into the air to punch flying dragons!

RING OF PROTECTION

A simple, shiny ring that makes you slightly luckier and slightly harder to hit. It's perfect for a Monk who doesn't want to carry heavy shields or bulky gear.

COMBAT CHEAT SHEET

Battles can be crazy! Use this quick guide to remember what you can do on your turn.

1. YOUR ACTION (PICK ONE!)

- **Attack:** Hit with your staff, spear, or fists! (Remember, at Level 5 you get to attack TWICE per Action!)
- **Dodge:** Make yourself almost impossible to hit!
- **Dash:** Double your amazing movement speed to run super far!

2. YOUR BONUS ACTION (THIS IS WHERE MONKS SHINE!)

- **Unarmed Strike:** If you attacked with your Action, you get one free punch or kick!
- **Flurry of Blows (1 Ki):** Do TWO super-fast punches instead of one!
- **Patient Defense (1 Ki):** Take the Dodge action so nobody can hit you!
- **Step of the Wind (1 Ki):** Disengage (run away safely) and double your jump distance!

3. YOUR REACTION (NOT ON YOUR TURN!)

- **Deflect Missiles:** If someone shoots an arrow at you, catch it! (If you spend 1 Ki point, you can even throw it back at them!)
- **Attack of Opportunity:** If an enemy tries to run away from you, give them a spinning kick to stop them!

DRAW YOUR HERO!

Every legendary hero needs a portrait. What does your Monk look like? Are they doing a cool karate kick? What kind of martial arts outfit do they wear?

- **What is your Monk's name?**

- **What is your favorite martial arts move?**

- **What is your favorite food to eat after training?**

